BIOIN4GIRLS 2020: BRAZILIAN (WOMEN) SYMPOSIUM IN BIOINFORMATICS

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INTRODUCTION

Women are underrepresented in bioinformatics[1], despite its foundation by Margaret Dayhoff. Remarkable differences are observed between the gender ratio for bioinformatics' parent fields, with biology being more balanced than computer science. In Brazil, most workshops and scientific events feature only men as speakers. Even when females are represented, they are often the minority.

OBJECTIVES

To organize an online event with talks spanning seven major topics in bioinformatics, all given by female researchers. Especifically:

- To promote ethnicity and gender identity diversity among speakers and organizers.
- To give visibility to women researchers and their contributions to bioinformatics while giving room to newcomers.

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AUDIENCE'S AFFILIATION

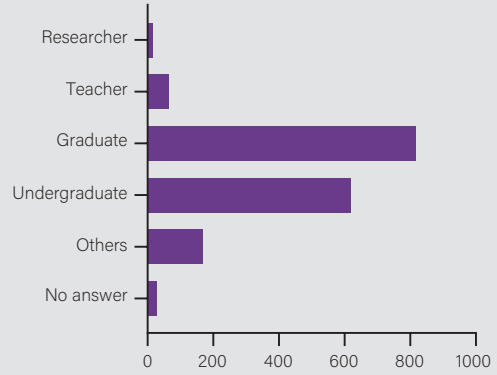

Figure 1. Barplot showing the audience's answer to the question: "What's your current affiliation?"

AUDIENCE'S EXPERIENCE WITH BIOINFORMATICS

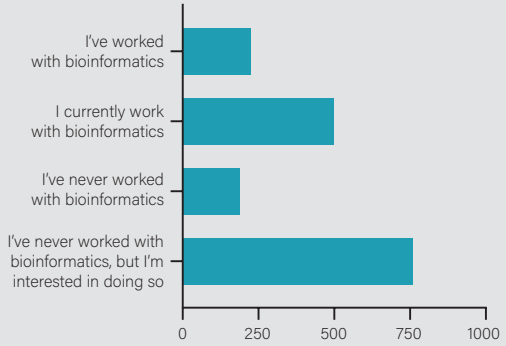

Figure 2. Barplot showing the audience's answer to the question: "Have you ever worked or are you currently working with bioinformatics?"

AUDIENCE'S EXPERIENCE WITH DIFFERENT TOPICS

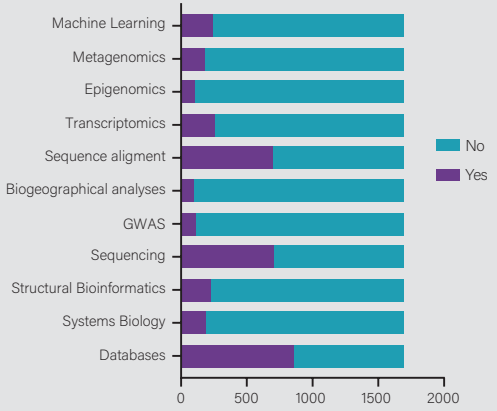

Figure 3. Barplot showing audience's answer to the question: "Which of these topics have you worked with?"

AUDIENCE'S INTERESTS

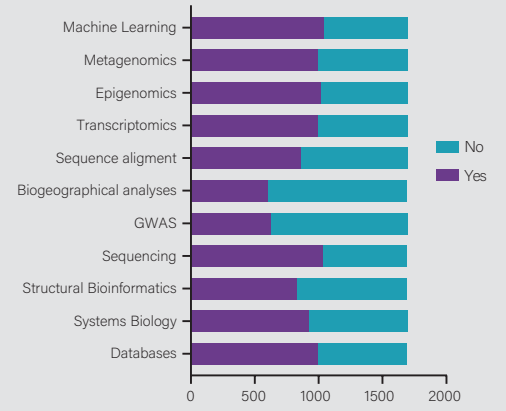

Figure 4. Barplot showing the audience's answer to the question: "Which of these topics are you interested in?"

METHODS

The symposium took place online, twice a week, from October 6th until November 5th, 2020. The organizing committee was composed only by women. We used the platform StreamYard to broadcast the talks on YouTube. The lectures were given in portuguese and remain available on our Youtube channel.

RESULTS AND CONCLUSIONS

The event audience comprehended 1705 registered attendees from 26 states of Brazil and 18 countries. Great majority was female, as expected. Most were graduate students (fig. 1), and most had never worked with bioinformatics, but were interested in doing so (fig. 2). Most had already worked with databases and sequencing (fig. 3) and machine learning was one of the most expected topics (fig. 4). To our best knowledge, BioIn4Girls was the first symposium on bioinformatics in Brazil to feature exclusively women as speakers, with a great receptivity.

REFERENCES

1. Bonham, K. S., & Stefan, M. I. (2017). Women are underrepresented in computational biology: An analysis of the scholarly literature in biology, computer science and computational biology. PLOS Computational Biology, 13(10), e1005134. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pcbi.1005134

PPGBM Programa de Pós-Graduação em Genética e Biologia Molecular da UFRGS
HOSPITAL DE CLÍNICAS
BioIn4Girls
iSCB INTERNATIONAL SOCIETY FOR COMPUTATIONAL BIOLOGY
ISMB ECCB 2021 VIRTUAL